The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY · KEY NUMBERS · FROM THE INBOX · ON X · CYCLE TRACKER · EVENTS

US WEDNESDAY — MEMORY RALLY
Micron +11.89% $811.30; Sandisk $977.69 +13.69% · SOX 10,564.11 +5.66% · Nvidia −8–9% after hours · Yahoo Finance, Reuters

KOREA THURSDAY — CLOSE · DRAM SPOT
KOSPI 5,342.73 −0.61%; Samsung ₩208,000 +0.97% · SK hynix ₩1,254,000 −1.80% · DDR4 16Gb $79.374 (−0.62%) · KRX via Naver, TrendForce

LEAD STORY

MARKETS · NVIDIA · SPOT

Memory Stocks Post Their Best Day in Months, Then Nvidia's Leadership Crisis Clouds the Rally

CoreWeave's results sent Micron up 11.9% and Sandisk up 13.7% on Wednesday. After the close, reports that Nvidia's board was meeting to decide whether to remove Jensen Huang knocked Nvidia down 8–9% in extended trading. Seoul split on Thursday: Samsung rose, SK hynix slipped.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · ~08:40 IST Thursday (UTC+2) · Korea = final close · US = Wednesday close · Spot TrendForce Nov 12 11:00 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · KOREA THURSDAY CLOSE · US WEDNESDAY CLOSE · SPOT THURSDAY

KOREA, THURSDAY CLOSE

KOSPI	**5,342.73 (−0.61%)**
Samsung	**₩208,000 (+0.97%)**
SK hynix	**₩1,254,000 (−1.80%)**
DDR5 16Gb spot	**$60.23 (0.00%)**
DDR4 16Gb spot	**$79.37 (−0.62%)**

US, WEDNESDAY CLOSE

Micron	**$811.30 (+11.89%)**
Sandisk	**$977.69 (+13.69%)**
SK hynix ADR	**$142.25 (+9.71%)**
SOX	**10,564.11 (+5.66%)**
Nvidia	**$173.73 (+2.87%)**

What this shows: the rally came before the Nvidia news. Every stock in the SOX rose on Wednesday; after hours Nvidia fell 8–9% and Micron about 2% (Reuters). In Seoul, Samsung held its gains and SK hynix gave some back. DRAM spot was flat for DDR5 and weaker for DDR4. NAND wafer spot ($16.15) is still the Nov 2 print. Sources: Yahoo Finance, Reuters via Investing.com, CNBC, KRX via Naver Finance, TrendForce.

CoreWeave's third-quarter beat set off the move. Chief executive Michael Intrator told CNBC that the company has 10 times as much demand as its remaining 2027 capacity, and that 2028 capacity is already oversubscribed several times over; it set 2026 capex at $37–39 billion (Yahoo Finance). Every SOX member rose (Reuters); Nvidia gained 2.87% in the session.

After the bell, The Wall Street Journal reported that Nvidia's board was preparing to remove Huang. The New York Times reported a second relationship, with an executive who reported to him. CNBC and Reuters confirmed a board meeting on Wednesday night; no decision had been announced by Thursday morning. Nvidia reports on Nov. 17. Samsung and SK hynix are monitoring succession scenarios; one official said business talks could slow, while others said supply agreements were unlikely to be affected

(Yonhap). In Seoul, the KOSPI closed at 5,342.73 (−0.61%), Samsung at ₩208,000 (+0.97%) and SK hynix at ₩1,254,000 (−1.80%); preliminary data show foreigners net bought about ₩347.8bn. DRAM spot was soft: DDR5 16Gb was flat at $60.233 and DDR4 16Gb fell 0.62% to $79.374, its largest drop of the week.

Our call: late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028. Unchanged overall: enterprise a touch firmer, PC and consumer a touch looser. CYCLE SIGNAL: ENTERPRISE FIRM, CONSUMER SOFTENING

PRICES · ENTERPRISE VS CONSUMER

Memory Makers Flag New Enterprise Price Hikes as PC Makers Sit on Inventory

Several leading memory makers have verbally told distributors they plan to raise prices for enterprise memory chips, and channel prices have already begun rising, Lanjing News reported, as summarized by TrendForce on Thursday. The increases are concentrated in DRAM contracts and enterprise SSDs, not consumer parts. In Shenzhen, 16GB DDR5 modules were quoted around RMB 1,600, below a reported RMB 2,000 average contract price for consumer modules, a price inversion. TrendForce said notebook shipments fell 15.8% q/q in 3Q26 and OEM DRAM inventory weeks have risen since then. It forecasts PC DRAM contract prices up 13–18% q/q in 4Q26, slower than last quarter, client SSDs below 5%, and enterprise SSDs up 15–20%. Suppliers tentatively plan to cut PC DRAM supply in 2027. Counterpoint: third-quarter DRAM revenue rose 369% y/y to just under $200 billion on shipments up about 4% (TechRadar).

HBM · CAPACITY

Samsung Breaks Ground on a ₩46 Trillion HBM Packaging Hub as Altman Warns of 'Double-Counted' Demand

Samsung broke ground on Line 5 at its Onyang campus, an advanced HBM packaging line due to start in June 2028, a year earlier than planned. It will invest ₩46 trillion there, ₩6 trillion for construction and ₩40 trillion for equipment installed in stages; Samsung says customers want more HBM than the 2027 volumes already agreed (Korea Times). SK hynix's HBM4 yield has reportedly passed 70%; the company does not disclose yields (Chosunbiz). REPORTED OpenAI's Sam Altman told about 50 Samsung affiliate presidents on Oct. 31 that "there has been double-counting of demand," with only OpenAI and Anthropic driving major growth, so "there could be a supply shock and an unsettled period." He still expects demand to grow enormously (Financial News, Nov 11). Kioxia plans to mass-produce 332-layer 10th-generation NAND as early as 2027 (Nikkei, via X).

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE WED ~08:00 IST · READ-ONLY

NEW **AI capex: another ~$500bn in 2027.** AI hardware and software spending runs above $900bn annualized by end-2026 and about $1.4tn by end-2027; 2027 real business investment is seen up 8% vs a 4.2% consensus. New data-center moratoria would likely hit only unpermitted projects. Goldman Sachs Economics (Nov 11)

NEW **CoreWeave re-prices old GPUs.** The CEO says H100s coming off contract in 2027 are being re-leased at a 20–50% premium; about $9bn of prepayments and deposits are lined up; 1.7 GW is in the ground, 1.85 GW by year-end. TMTB podcast digest, CNBC interview (Nov 11)

SUPPLY CHAIN **No order cuts at Taiwan ODMs.** Wistron sees GB300 shipments reaching 6,000 racks in 4Q26 and no customer cuts since the midterms. Inventec says shortages of memory, CPUs, hard drives and passives could hold back fourth-quarter shipments. Jefferies Asia TMT (Nov 12); Semi Doped daily citing Taipei Times (Nov 11)

ON X · SINCE WED ~08:00 · IST

@jukan05 · Nov 11 15:02
Altman to Samsung executives: “There has been some double counting of demand… OpenAI and Anthropic are the only two companies really driving substantial growth.”
x.com/…/2120502530652430402

@pequityresearch · Nov 12 03:10
SK hynix HBM4 yield reportedly at 70% vs Samsung’s 80%: 60%→70% yield means ~16.7% more good units from the same input. UNCONFIRMED
x.com/…/2120685678962892845

@pequityresearch · Nov 12 06:14
Yuanta’s bottleneck map: memory and advanced packaging peak in 2027, optical interconnects in 2028, power in 2030.
x.com/…/2120731813345710501

@SemiAnalysis_ · Nov 11 20:03
TPU 8i Max carries 384GB of HBM per chip, a move to 8-hi stacks from 12-hi, following Nvidia’s 8-hi plan for Rubin Ultra; HBM bandwidth per package doubles.
x.com/…/2120578135594791297

@dnystedt · Nov 12 02:30
Nikkei: Kioxia to mass-produce 332-layer 10th-gen NAND (from 218) as early as 2027, with 30% better read power efficiency.
x.com/…/2120675638478832040

CYCLE TRACKER · ENTERPRISE A TOUCH FIRMER; PC/CONSUMER A TOUCH LOOSER

GAUGE	TODAY VS NOV 11 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	Enterprise DRAM/SSD hikes flagged to distributors (Lanjing via TrendForce). PC DRAM 4Q26 +13–18% q/q, slower than 3Q; enterprise SSD +15–20%; client SSD <5%	**Rising, slower in PC**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 16Gb $60.23 (0.00%); DDR4 16Gb $79.37 (−0.62%), 8Gb $44.71 (−0.40%). Shenzhen DDR5 16GB module ~RMB 1,600 vs ~RMB 2,000 contract (inversion)	**Softer (consumer)**
Inventory / demand	PC OEM DRAM inventory weeks rising since 3Q26; notebooks −15.8% q/q. CoreWeave 10× oversubscribed for 2027; Altman: some demand “double-counted”	**Amber**
Supply growth / capex	Samsung ₩46T Onyang HBM packaging, line 5 June 2028 (a year early). SK hynix HBM4 yield >70% (reported). Kioxia 332-layer NAND from 2027. Suppliers plan PC DRAM cuts in 2027	**HBM supply up from 2028**
Valuation	MU +11.89%, SNDK +13.69% on Wednesday, then Nvidia −8–9% after hours. Yuanta sees the memory bottleneck peaking in 2027	**Volatile**

VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 36, NOV 11)
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028. Unchanged overall, with enterprise and consumer moving apart. Enterprise and AI memory is a touch firmer: new enterprise DRAM and SSD hikes, CoreWeave 10× oversubscribed for 2027, and Samsung’s HBM packaging line pulled forward a year. PC and consumer memory is a touch looser: PC DRAM contract gains slowing to 13–18%, OEM inventory weeks rising (amber in the playbook) and DDR4 spot −0.62%. Altman’s “double counting” remark and Nvidia’s leadership crisis add demand-quality risk. The playbook’s top signal (DDR5 spot falling while contract rises) has not appeared.

EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 12–25 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

Thu Nov 12	Nebius before the open · Hon Hai results · Applied Materials (call 23:30), Cisco and SMIC after the close · Advantest IR fireside chat · Nvidia board outcome awaited	WFE
Fri Nov 13	US PPI (October) 15:30	Macro
Tue Nov 17	Nvidia FQ3 (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 Nov 17–19	HBM

Wed Nov 18–20	Requested House briefing by Huang (18th) · Sandisk 8-for-1 split after Nov 19 close · Anthropic IPO pricing expected	NAND
Mon Nov 23–24	HPE results (est.) · Jefferies EM conference, Dubai · Watch: Korea Nov 1–20 exports, TrendForce NAND weekly and month-end contract prices	Prices

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #37 · Nov 12, 2026